

The Wordhoard Map

Every layer in the model, from the sources at the bottom to the votes at the top, and where each one stands. Read it upward: each band sits on the one below it.

THE READER

WHAT THE READER SEES

The word page — words and things, both sides live · search and home · provenance on every card · browse
Later: feeds, the JSON API, the progressive web app, iOS. Every surface reads the bands below and shows

THE CULTURE

EXAMPLES · PLANNED, SKETCHED IN S5

"X is an example of this word, sense or thing"

a person — a thing of its own: Don Jr. for nepotism
a poem, a painting, a passage of text
a link: a YouTube video, a TikTok, a news story
kind · status (pending → accepted) · score

nominate · vote

QUOTES · MEDIA · PLANNED

quotes, with provenance
scoring for misattribution (#6)
the evidence wall: links
unfurled into one feed (#67)
attach to senses and things

THE LEXICON — WORDS

SENSES

a dictionary's meanings
Wiktionary: 25 senses of cat
WordNet: 8 synsets of cat
many per word, never merged

ENTRIES

an author's text on a word
Bierce's joke · Johnson's
definition and quotations
Wikipedia's, via the thing

attach to a word (lemma + part of speech)

WORDS

lexemes: one row per lemma and part of speech
cat · noun — cat · verb — oyster · adjective
forms fold in (cats, oystered) · spellings fold in (oistre → oyster)
1.54 M rows: every English word, from day one

NAMES

concept_links
method · score

THE ENC

THING ·
concept
→ the c
→ kinds
→ exam

THINGS

concept
cat → C
seal → C
cat → th

relate word to word

WORD ↔ WORD

lexical_relations — forms and variants · similar · opposite
broader / narrower · parts · part of · family · see-also
1.2 M edges; the hop

materialize — every row

SOURCES

🔥 THE ARISTOCRACY OF THE DEAD

Bierce 1911 · Johnson 1755

static books, committed and pinned
later: Webster 1913, EB1911
their words outrank everyone's

📖 THE INSTITUTIONS

WordNet · Wiktionary · Wikipedia · Wikidata

dumps and APIs, pinned by date
raw kept, trimmed, rebuilt offline
later: Merriam-Webster

built, and on the page now

built

planned — the tables are sketched, nothing is s

The model in seven bands. Words and things are different tables that meet only through scored links; definitions and relations attach to words, the chain and the kinds attach to

things, and the culture attaches to all three. Solid boxes exist; a thick outline means the reader can see it on the page today; dashed is planned.

Nepotism, traced through the bands

Your own example, as the database holds it this morning and as the plan finishes it.

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- 1 **Sources.** Two aristocrats have the word. Bierce: *"Appointing your grandmother to office for the good of the party."* Johnson has an entry too. WordNet has one sense. Wiktionary has the word in the index but no senses yet, because nepotism is outside both scopes; its senses arrive with the whole-lexicon pass.

 - 2 **Word.** One row: *nepotism* · *noun*. Its page exists now at /define/nepotism.

 - 3 **Definitions.** Bierce's, Johnson's and WordNet's, side by side in tier order. If they contradict each other, the page shows the contradiction; it never picks a winner.

 - 4 **Word to word.** Today: broader words *favoritism* and *discrimination* from WordNet. After the Wiktionary pass: *nepotist*, *nepotistic* as family, *cronyism* as similar, and the antonyms.

 - 5 **Thing.** Nepotism is a thing in Wikidata, a social practice with a Wikipedia article. It is not linked yet, for the same reason: linking runs per scope. The link is one task run away, and it carries a confidence.

 - 6 **Examples.** Someone nominates *Donald Trump Jr.* He is a thing of his own, a person with a Wikidata item, so the example is a link from the thing *nepotism* to the thing *Donald Trump Jr.*, submitted by a user, pending until accepted. Someone else nominates a YouTube clip, which is a URL example, and a poem, which is a text example.

 - 7 **Votes.** People and curator bots vote each example up or down. The score orders them, so the personality most people think represents the word rises to the top of the page.
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What you described, and where it lives

YOU SAID	IN THE MODEL	STATUS
A dictionary and an encyclopedia in one	The lexicon (words, senses, entries) and the encyclopedia (things) are two sides that meet through scored links	built
Definitions sit on top of words	senses and entries attach to a word by lemma and part of speech	built, on the page
A word can have many definitions	many senses per word; cat has 25 in Wiktionary and 8 synsets in WordNet	built, on the page
Same spelling, different meanings	separate senses under one word, and where they name different things, separate things: cat the animal and cat the Unix command	built, both halves on the page
Sources that contradict each other	every definition belongs to its source and sits beside the others; nothing is merged; a thing-level disagreement gets a plaque	built, and the plaque is on the page
Conjugations and forms	forms fold into the headword; <i>oysters</i> lands on <i>oyster</i> with a note; variants are a chip group	built, on the page
Synonyms, antonyms, other relations	lexical_relations, grouped as similar, opposite, broader, narrower, parts, part of, family, see-also	built, on the page
Taxonomy and other hierarchies	concept_relations: taxonomy for living things, classes and instances for everything else; the chain, the kinds, the examples of a thing	built, on the page

YOU SAID	IN THE MODEL	STATUS
A person as an example of nepotism	examples: a link from a word, sense or thing to another thing, a URL or a text, with a status and a score	planned; tables sketched and proven to fit
A poem, art, a YouTube video as an example	the same table: text and URL kinds; media unfurls into the evidence wall	planned (#67)
Quotes	a quote layer with provenance scoring, attached to senses and things	planned (#65)
People cannot write definitions	senses and entries require a source row; users and bots are sources of the crowd tier, and the crowd tier owns examples and votes only	a rule of the model
People vote on which example fits best	votes of ± 1 by a person or a curator bot; the score orders the examples on the page	planned (#17 for the bots)

Does it fit?

Yes. Everything you listed has a place, and nothing built so far points anywhere else. The one distinction worth holding onto is the middle of the map: a definition is something a source says about a *word*, while an example is something the culture attaches to a *thing*, or to a word or a sense when there is no thing. Don Jr. exemplifies nepotism the practice, not the string n-e-p-o-t-i-s-m. That is why the thing side has to exist before the culture layer does, and why U1b comes before the examples.

Two rules the model enforces rather than promises. First, nothing appears without a source: a person's example is a row from a crowd-tier source, and it is dressed as one. Second, the crowd can nominate and vote but never define. The definitions stay with the dictionaries and the dead.

What is still open is design, not structure: how a page with a Bierce joke, eight WordNet senses, a taxonomy chain, a top-voted example and a wall of clips stays

readable. That is the design pass in #66, after the pages exist.